popular book *The Coming Currency Collapse*, a terrifying rationale for the total collapse of the U.S. dollar, sold out several editions just as the dollar began its remarkable three-year bull market.

Megatrends, a summer favorite in 1983, predicted the triumph of high technology and pronounced the smokestack industries dead. Along with its extraordinary popular acceptance came a genuine depression in the microchip and computer industries and a huge drop in the value of technology stocks, while smokestack industries revived.

Now I was onto a tactic that seemed foolproof. Since I counted myself as an average investor, I'd simply do the opposite of anything that struck me as profitable. This idea was so exciting that I thanked Mr. Socolow under my breath, and then jotted down Useful Tip Number Six:

If you think it's right, then it's wrong—and vice versa

As quickly as possible, I quit the library for my own bedroom, where I spent several days watching the Financial News Network on television. With great concentration, I waited to be persuaded of something so I could do just the opposite. With the continuous ticker tape running across the bottom of this channel, the flow of symbols put me into the usual semihypnotic state and heightened my susceptibility to suggestion. Soon, a man from a Colorado investment service said we were going back into a deflationary period. Since I was absolutely convinced he was right, I leapt up and went looking for my wife, to tell her that the country was going into an inflationary period and we should invest in gold, natural resources, and other hard assets.

I returned to the television, where a half hour later an MIT economist said we really were going into an inflationary period, that we'd soon be in a credit crunch and the government would have to inflate its way out of debt. To me this could only mean one thing: deflation. I cornered my wife again, to inform her I'd changed my mind. Since hard assets were losing propositions, I'd